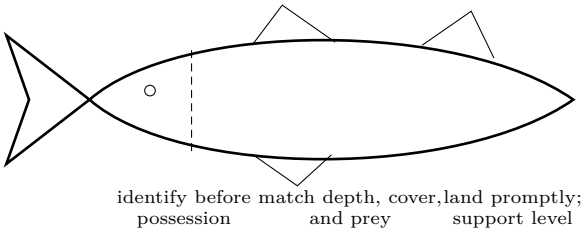


Recognize it	Lake role						
Stocky olive sunfish with red eye and rows of dark side spots.	Where it belongs Rock, wood, docks, shade, and firm transitions.						
<table><tr><td>Body</td><td>More elongate than bluegill; five to seven anal spines.</td></tr><tr><td>Mouth/fins</td><td>Mouth reaches beneath eye; continuous dorsal with strong spines.</td></tr><tr><td>Confusion</td><td>Warmouth has three anal spines and radiating dark cheek lines.</td></tr></table>	Body	More elongate than bluegill; five to seven anal spines.	Mouth/fins	Mouth reaches beneath eye; continuous dorsal with strong spines.	Confusion	Warmouth has three anal spines and radiating dark cheek lines.	Food and season Crayfish, insects, and small fish; often close to bottom or hard cover.
Body	More elongate than bluegill; five to seven anal spines.						
Mouth/fins	Mouth reaches beneath eye; continuous dorsal with strong spines.						
Confusion	Warmouth has three anal spines and radiating dark cheek lines.						

A fish-shaped decision, not a lure list



Find it on these waters

Pine	Test rocky points, hard-bottom breaks, and shade where accessible.
North	Test wood, riprap, narrows, and firm spots beside weeds.
Evidence	The DNR lake records sometimes name only a broad group such as panfish. In that case this species is a candidate member, not verified individual presence. Confirm presence before targeting; treat locations as testable habitat hypotheses, not abundance findings.

Presentations

- 1. **Small jig.** Hop a compact plastic or hair jig through rock; pause in gaps.
- 2. **Live-bait float.** Suspend worm or small minnow beside cover, not inside the snag.
- 3. **Stop rule.** If only tiny fish bite, move to the next deeper hard edge.

HANDLING DECIDES THE OUTCOME

Beware dorsal and anal spines; wet hands and cradle the fish.

Water-specific rule	Open all year; no minimum; rock/yellow/white bass daily bag unlimited on both lake pages.
Kitchen choice	Keep thicker mid-size fish that yield usable fillets; stop at the planned meal despite no daily limit.
Before the trip	Open the Wisconsin DNR water-specific regulation page for WBIC 779200 (Pine) or 850800 (North). Check the exact water, species, and date; the live rule controls if this dated sheet differs.

Keep only a fish you can use

Decide before the cast. Bring ice, stop fishing when the planned meal is secured, and use the species-specific cooking guide for dispatch, bone layout, and safe preparation. Large old predators are valuable spawners and generally carry more mercury than smaller fish.

Sources checked 2026-07-26. Wisconsin DNR lake fish records (Pine WBIC 779200; North WBIC 850800), Wisconsin’s Fishes, Hook Your Catch, 2026–27 water-specific regulations, Catch-and-release Guidelines, and Eating Your Catch. Biological and tactical synthesis is editorial; it is not a current population survey.

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